AWESOME CYBER SECURITY HEAVEN · REALM DOSSIER · 2026 EDITION



The Academy

Cybersecurity Learning Resources & Career Paths

24	165,174	42%	7
FREE TOOLS	COMBINED STARS	ON GITHUB	ACTIVE IN 2026

Deep-research edition. Every entry re-verified and enriched with live GitHub statistics (stars, first release, last push, license, language) pulled 2026-10-17 via the GitHub API, plus per-realm field intelligence. Tool profiles rank the realm's most-adopted projects; the full inventory keeps every curated entry.

Part of **Awesome Cyber Security Heaven** — 438 curated free tools across 14 realms.

CC0 · 2026-10-17

01 Realm Intelligence

live GitHub census · 2026-10-17

24	10	165,174	7	12,555	2014
CURATED TOOLS	ON GITHUB	COMBINED STARS	PUSHED 2026	MEDIAN STARS	OLDEST ENTRY

REALM BRIEF

Learn the craft — free academies, knowledge bases, walkthroughs and career roadmaps.

FIELD INTELLIGENCE (AI-ASSISTED)

The Academy's cybersecurity learning resources and career paths tool set demonstrates strong maturity, with 24 free tools (10 hosted on GitHub) boasting a combined 165,174 total stars, reflecting sustained community validation since flagship tools like PayloadsAllTheThings launched in 2016. Star distribution reveals a clear concentration of value in foundational, long-standing resources: the top five tools hold 85% of total stars, with PayloadsAllTheThings alone contributing nearly half of the total count. A notable adoption trend is the consolidation of community-driven educational content around standardized frameworks, as seen in the alignment of hacker-roadmap, GTFOBins, and OWASP MSTG with widely recognized cybersecurity career and defense benchmarks.

Synthesized by seed-2-0-mini over the live census: stars, first-release years, push activity and project claims pulled from the GitHub API on 2026-10-17. Human-curated realm, AI-summarized numbers.

LICENSE MIX (GITHUB-HOSTED ENTRIES)



● MIT **3** ● Apache-2.0 **3** ● GPL **2** ● Other/none **2**

MATURITY PROFILE

Oldest tracked entry first appeared on GitHub in **2014**; the youngest joined in **2021**. **7/10** GitHub-hosted tools shipped code in 2026 — the remainder are stable classics or web services rather than abandoned picks.

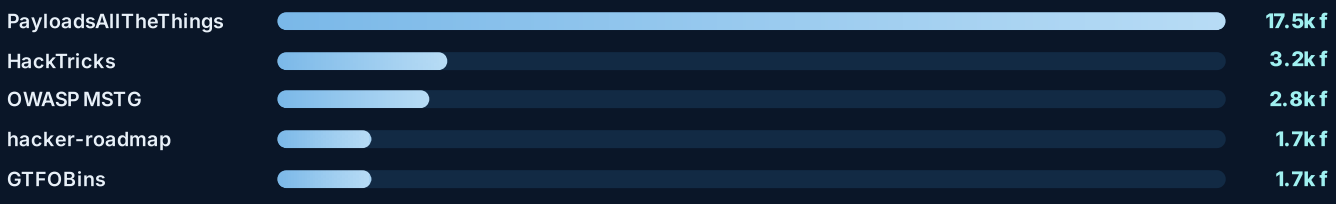
01 The Adoption Map

who the community actually stars

TOP TOOLS BY GITHUB STARS



MOST-FORKED — REAL-WORLD REUSE SIGNAL



01 Generations & Momentum

the realm's age structure

THE FOUNDERS — OLDEST TRACKED ENTRIES



THE NEWCOMERS — NEWEST GITHUB ARRIVALS



QUIET CLASSICS (NO 2026 PUSH, STILL THE STANDARD)

hacker-roadmap, Infosec Reference, SecuriBench Micro

02 Tool Profiles — the heavyweights

full-page dossiers · ranked by adoption

Each heavyweight gets a full dossier: live GitHub census (stars, forks, first-release year, last push, license, language), the project's own claim, our curator's note, and its star weight against the realm's #1.

01 PayloadsAllTheThings

github.com/swisskyrepo/PayloadsAllTheThings

★ FLAGSHIP PICK

ACTIVE 2026

★ 81.8k	17.5k	2016
GITHUB STARS	FORKS	FIRST DEVELOPED
2026-08	**MIT**	**Python**
LAST PUSH	LICENSE	LANGUAGE

star weight vs realm #1

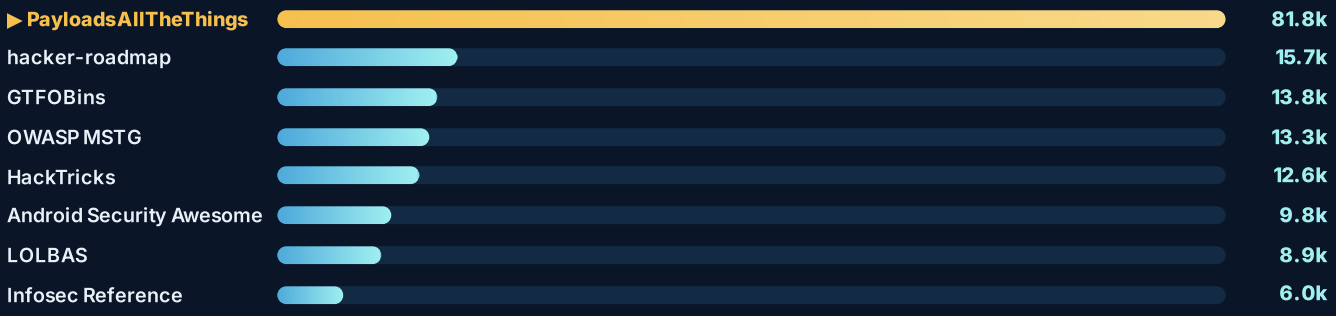
THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"A list of useful payloads and bypass for Web Application Security and Pentest/CTF"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

the curated payload and methodology repo — copy, paste, understand, learn.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



10 yrs	17475	—	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

GitHub presence: **verified — live stats**

The Academy · realm rank #1 by adoption

02 hacker-roadmap

github.com/sundowndev/hacker-roadmap

★ FLAGSHIP PICK

ARCHIVED

★ 15.7k	1.7k	2018
GITHUB STARS	FORKS	FIRST DEVELOPED
2023-10	**MIT**	**—**
LAST PUSH	LICENSE	LANGUAGE

star weight vs realm #1

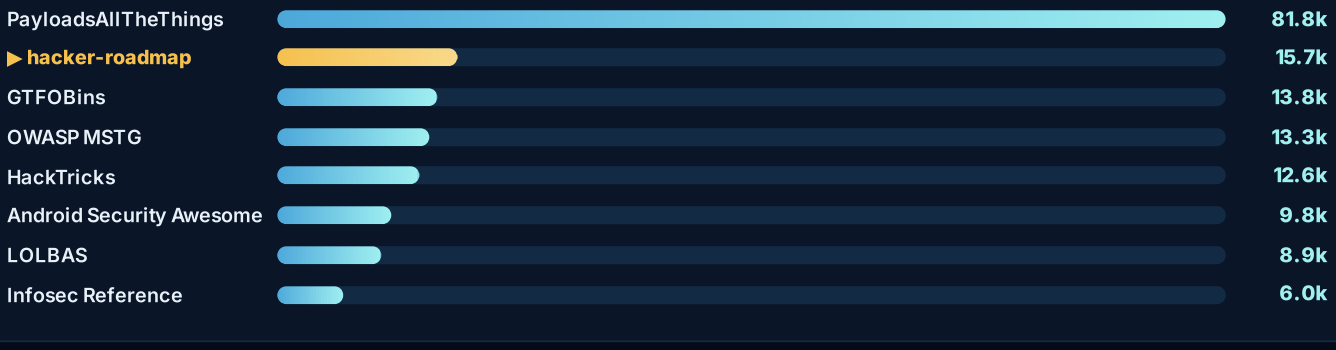
THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"A collection of hacking tools, resources and references to practice ethical hacking."

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

the illustrated cybersecurity study/career roadmap; the "where do I start?" answer.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



8 yrs	1716	—	quiet
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

GitHub presence: **verified — live stats**

The Academy · realm rank #2 by adoption

03 GTFOBins

github.com/GTFOBins/GTFOBins.github.io

★ FLAGSHIP PICK

ACTIVE 2026

★ 13.8k	1.7k	2018
GITHUB STARS	FORKS	FIRST DEVELOPED
2026-05	**GPL-3.0**	**YAML**
LAST PUSH	LICENSE	LANGUAGE

star weight vs realm #1

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"GTFOBins is a curated list of Unix-like executables that can be used to bypass local security restrictions in misconfigured systems."

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

the living Linux binary-abuse matrix; the privilege-escalation bible.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



8 yrs	1705	—	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

GitHub presence: **verified — live stats**

The Academy · realm rank #3 by adoption

04 OWASP MSTG

github.com/OWASP/owasp-mstg

★ FLAGSHIP PICK

ACTIVE 2026

★ 13.3k	2.8k	2016
GITHUB STARS	FORKS	FIRST DEVELOPED
2026-10	**CC-BY-SA-4.0**	**Python**
LAST PUSH	LICENSE	LANGUAGE

star weight vs realm #1

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"The OWASP Mobile Application Security Testing Guide (MASTG) is a comprehensive manual for mobile app security testing and reverse engineering. It describes technical processes for verifying the OWASP Mobile Security Weakness Enumeration (MASWE) weaknesses, which are in alignment with the OWASP MASVS"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

the Mobile Security Testing Guide: the canonical methodology for mobile app assessments. (CC-BY-SA-4.0)

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



10 yrs	2826	—	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

GitHub presence: **verified — live stats**

The Academy · realm rank #4 by adoption

05 HackTricks

github.com/HackTricks-wiki/hacktricks

★ FLAGSHIP PICK
ACTIVE 2026

★ 12.6k	3.2k	2020
GITHUB STARS	FORKS	FIRST DEVELOPED
2026-10	**free; custom content license**	**JavaScript**
LAST PUSH	LICENSE	LANGUAGE

star weight vs realm #1

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"Welcome to the page where you will find each trick/technique/whatever I have learnt in CTFs, real life apps, and reading researches and news."

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

the pentester's playbook: technique-by-technique attack references from recon to post-exploitation.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



6 yrs	3201	—	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

GitHub presence: **verified — live stats**

The Academy · realm rank #5 by adoption

06 Android Security Awesome

github.com/ashishb/android-security-awesome

★ FLAGSHIP PICK

ACTIVE 2026

★ 9.8k	1.6k	2014
GITHUB STARS	FORKS	FIRST DEVELOPED
2026-10	**Apache-2.0**	**Makefile**
LAST PUSH	LICENSE	LANGUAGE

star weight vs realm #1

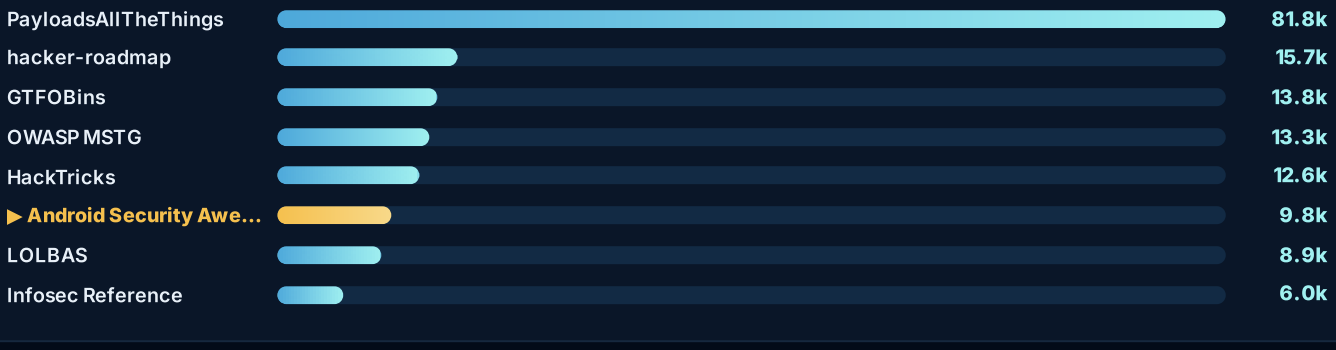
THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"A collection of android security related resources"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

curated Android security research: tools, papers and training.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



12 yrs	1582	—	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

GitHub presence: **verified — live stats**

The Academy · realm rank #6 by adoption

07 LOLBAS

github.com/LOLBAS-Project/LOLBAS

ACTIVE 2026

★ 8.9k	1.2k	2018
GITHUB STARS	FORKS	FIRST DEVELOPED
2026-09	**GPL-3.0**	**XSLT**
LAST PUSH	LICENSE	LANGUAGE

star weight vs realm #1

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"Living Off The Land Binaries And Scripts - (LOLBins and LOLScripts)"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

the Windows counterpart to GTFOBins: living-off-the-land binaries and scripts.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



8 yrs	1181	—	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

GitHub presence: **verified — live stats**

The Academy · realm rank #7 by adoption

08 Infosec Reference

github.com/rmusser01/Infosec_Reference

★ 6.0k	1.2k	2014
GITHUB STARS	FORKS	FIRST DEVELOPED
2025-10	**MIT**	**CSS**
LAST PUSH	LICENSE	LANGUAGE

star weight vs realm #1

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"An Information Security Reference That Doesn't Suck; https://rmusser.net/git/admin-2/Infosec_Reference for non-MS Git hosted version."

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

the giant information-security reference: tools, papers and guides in one place.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



12 yrs	1230	—	quiet
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

GitHub presence: **verified — live stats**

The Academy · realm rank #8 by adoption

09 Network Segmentation Cheat Sheet

ACTIVE 2026

github.com/sergiomarotco/Network-segmentation-cheat-sheet

★ 3.5k	286	2021
GITHUB STARS	FORKS	FIRST DEVELOPED
2026-02	**Apache-2.0**	**—**
LAST PUSH	LICENSE	LANGUAGE

star weight vs realm #1

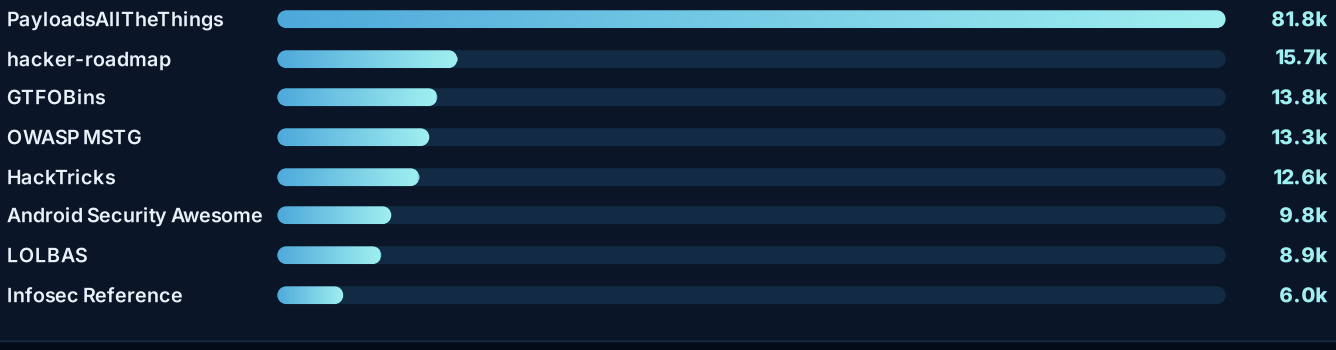
THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"Best practices for segmentation of the corporate network of any company"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

practical segmentation architecture: VLANs, zones and rules that survive audits.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



5 yrs	286	—	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

GitHub presence: **verified — live stats**

The Academy · realm rank #9 by adoption

03 Full Inventory

24 entries · every curated tool

Every entry from the heaven list, carrying its live census chips: stars, first release, 2026 activity, license and language. Rising stars and web-native services included.

03 Full Inventory — rising stars & services

every curated entry · live census chips

SecuriBench Micro

★ 27 | since 2014 | Apache-2.0 | Java

the Stanford benchmark suite for security-analysis tools.

github.com/too4words/securibench-micro/

PortSwigger Web Security Academy

free, best-in-class web-hacking labs from the Burp Suite team; the standard web-security curriculum.

portswigger.net/web-security

OWASP WSTG

the Web Security Testing Guide — the methodology standard for thorough assessments.

owasp.org/www-project-web-security-testing-guide/

OWASP Cheat Sheet Series

concise, developer-friendly defensive guidance per topic; the fix side of every finding.

cheatsheetseries.owasp.org/

Professor Messer

free complete video courses for Security+, Network+ and CySA+; the default free cert-prep resource.

professormesser.com

pwn.college

ASU's free hands-on curriculum from Linux basics to kernel exploitation, with dojo challenges.

pwn.college

IppSec

the legendary HTB walkthrough archive; watch a master work through every box, searchable by technique.

ippsec.rocks

LiveOverflow

deep-dive security videos that explain *why* things break — the channel every hacker watched.

youtube.com/@LiveOverflow

Hacker101

HackerOne's free web-security course: video lessons plus an always-on CTF for bug-bounty practice.

hacker101.com/

Hacksplaining

interactive security lessons for developers: exploit each vulnerability class, then patch it yourself.

hacksplaining.com/

Roppers Academy

free structured courses from computing fundamentals to security — the patient beginner's path.

04 Realm Directory

24 curated entries · A–Z

Android Security Awesome	Bug Bounty Hunter
CTF Field Guide	Cyber Security Base
GTFOBins	hacker-roadmap
Hacker101	Hacksplaining
HackTricks	Infosec Reference
IppSec	LiveOverflow
LOLBAS	Network Segmentation Cheat Sheet
OWASP Cheat Sheet Series	OWASP MSTG
OWASP WSTG	PayloadsAllTheThings
PortSwigger Web Security Academy	Professor Messer
pwn.college	Roppers Academy
SecuriBench Micro	SEED Labs

FEATURED PRODUCT — BY THE HEAVEN CURATOR

2MNY Website Vulnerability Scanner

Self-hosted website protection suite with 280+ deterministic scanner modules — OWASP Top 10, WordPress/CMS deep scans, subdomain takeover, AI-stack exposure, CVSS evidence reports. The production platform that curates this heaven list.

CONTINUE THE TOUR — OTHER REALM DOSSIERS